Believing the CIA's activities were doing more harm than good, Snowden experienced a crisis of conscience about working for the agency; he considered becoming a whistle-blower at that time. But the CIA relied heavily on spies and he was uncomfortable disclosing secrets that might endanger CIA agents or foreign recruits. Plus, Barack Obama had just been elected president in 2008, and Snowden appreciated Obama's pledge that he would not sacrifice individual rights in the name of

NEED FOR TECHNO-SPIES

The 9/11 terrorist attacks killed nearly 3,000 people on US soil. In the aftermath of the attacks, Americans were frightened and vulnerable, and the government was determined to avoid similar events. As a result, the US Congress fed massive amounts of money into intelligence organizations, including the NSA and CIA. Large chunks of that money went to private defense contractors, such as Dell and Booz Allen Hamilton, who hired—and continue to hire—talented young professionals such as Snowden to get the work done.

The dilemma for defense contractors is that people with technical skills sometimes have beliefs and lifestyles that do not fit well within a government bureaucracy. "There were lots of discussions at NSA and in the intelligence community in general about the acculturation process," Joel F. Brenner, a former inspector general of the NSA, told the *New York Times*. "They were aware that they were bringing in young people who had to adjust to the culture—and who would change the culture." He added that after the 9/11 attacks, "you're going to have some sloppiness and some mistakes." He found it remarkable that the "disloyalty" shown by Snowden did not happen more often.[4]

Copyright © 2016. ABDO Publishing Company. All rights reserved.

Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,